Specification of the controlled designation of origin “CHABLIS”

approved by the order of 11 December 2023 published in the JORF of 21 December 2023

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin “Chablis”, initially recognised by the decree of 13 January 1938.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

1° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by the term “premier cru” for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for that term in the present specification.

2° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by the term “premier cru” and followed by the name of one of the climats listed below, for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for the term “premier cru” in the present specification.

3° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be followed by the name of one of the climats listed below, for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for the term “premier cru” in the present specification.

LIST OF CLIMATS

- « Beauroy », « Côte de Savant », « Troesmes » ;
- « Berdiot » ;
- « Chaume de Talvat » ;
- « Côte de Jouan » ;
- « Côte de Léchet » ;
- « Côte de Vaubarousse » ;
- « Fourchaume », « Côte de Fontenay », « L'Homme Mort », « Vaulorent », « Vaupulent » ;
- « Les Beauregards », « Côte de Cuisy » ;
- « Les Fourneaux », « Côte des Prés-Girots », « Morein » ;
- « Mont de Milieu » ;
- « Montée de Tonnerre », « Chapelot », « Côte de Bréchain », « Pied d'Aloup » ;
- « Montmains », « Butteaux », « Forêts » ;
- « Vaillons », « Beugnons », « Chatains », « les Épinottes », « Les Lys », « Mélinots » ; « Roncières », « Sécher » ;
- « Vau de Vey », « Vaux Ragons » ;
- « Vau Ligneau » ;
- « Vaucoupin » ;
- « Vosgros », « Vaugiraut ».

4° – The name of the principal climat, indicated at the head of each group distinguished by a dash in the list above, may, in accordance with usages, be given to the wines coming from all the climats constituting the same group.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin “Chablis” is reserved for still white wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification and the elaboration of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes of the Yonne department: Beine, Béru, Chablis, La Chapelle-Vaupelteigne, Chemilly-sur-Serein, Chichée, Collan, Courgis, Fleys, Fontenay-près-Chablis, Lignorelles, Ligny-le- Châtel, Maligny, Poilly-sur-Serein, Préhy, Villy et Viviers.

2° – Delimited parcel area

a) – The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 31 January 1978.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

b) – The wines liable to benefit from the term "premier cru" come exclusively from vines situated within the particular production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 31 January 1978.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification and the elaboration of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes:

Côte-d'Or department: Agencourt, Aloxe-Corton, Ancey, Arcenant, Argilly, Autricourt, Auxey-Duresses, Baubigny, Beaune, Belan-sur-Ource, Bévy, Bissey-la-Côte, Bligny-lès-Beaune, Boncourt-le-Bois, Bouix, Bouze-lès-Beaune, Brion-sur-Ource, Brochon, Cérilly, Chambœuf, Chambolle-Musigny, Channay, Charrey-sur-Seine, Chassagne-Montrachet, Châtillon-sur-Seine, Chaumont-le-Bois, Chaux, Chenôve, Chevannes, Chorey-lès-Beaune, Clémencey, Collonges-lès-Bévy, Combertault, Comblanchien, Corcelles-les-Arts, Corcelles-les-Monts, Corgoloin, Cormot-le-Grand, Corpeau, Couchey, Curley, Curtil-Vergy, Daix, Dijon, Ebaty, Echevronne, Epernay-sous-Gevrey, L'Etang-Vergy, Etrochey, Fixin, Flagey-Echézeaux, Flavignerot, Fleurey-sur-Ouche, Fussey, Gerland, Gevrey-Chambertin, Gilly-lès-Cîteaux, Gomméville, Grancey-sur-Ource, Griselles, Ladoix-Serrigny, Lantenay, Larrey, Levernois, Magny-lès-Villers, Mâlain, Marcenay, Marey-lès-Fussey, Marsannay-la- Côte, Massingy, Mavilly-Mandelot, Meloisey, Merceuil, Messanges, Meuilley, Meursanges, Meursault, Molesme, Montagny-lès-Beaune, Monthelie, Montliot-et-Courcelles, Morey-Saint-Denis, Mosson, Nantoux, Nicey, Noiron-sur-Seine, Nolay, Nuits-Saint-Georges, Obtrée, Pernand-Vergelesses, Perrigny-lès-Dijon, Plombières-lès-Dijon, Poinçon-lès-Larrey, Pommard, Pothières, Premeaux-Prissey, Prusly-sur-Ource, Puligny-Montrachet, Quincey, Reulle-Vergy, La Rochepot, Ruffey-lès-Beaune, Saint-Aubin, Saint-Bernard, Saint-Philibert, Saint-Romain, Sainte-Colombe-sur-Seine, Sainte-Marie- la-Blanche, Santenay, Savigny-lès-Beaune, Segrois, Tailly, Talant, Thoires, Vannaire, Vauchignon, Velars-sur-Ouche, Vertault, Vignoles, Villars-Fontaine, Villebichot, Villedieu, Villers-la-Faye, Villers- Patras, Villy-le-Moutier, Vix, Volnay, Vosne-Romanée et Vougeot ;

Rhône department: Alix, Anse, L'Arbresle, Les Ardillats, Arnas, Bagnols, Beaujeu, Belleville, Belmont d'Azergues, Blacé, Le Bois-d'Oingt, Le Breuil, Bully, Cercié, Chambost-Allières, Chamelet, Charentay, Charnay, Châtillon, Chazay-d'Azergues, Chénas, Chessy, Chiroubles, Cogny, Corcelles-en- Beaujolais, Dareizé, Denicé, Dracé, Emeringes, Fleurie, Frontenas, Gleizé, Jarnioux, Juliénas, Jullié, Lacenas, Lachassagne, Lancié, Lantignié, Légny, Létra, Liergues, Limas, Lozanne, Lucenay, Marchampt, Marcy, Moiré, Montmelas-Saint-Sorlin, Morancé, Nuelles, Odenas, Oingt, Les Olmes, Le Perréon, Pommiers, Pouilly-le-Monial, Quincié-en-Beaujolais, Régnié-Durette, Rivolet, Saint-Clément- sur-Valsonne, Saint-Cyr-le-Chatoux, Saint-Didier-sur-Beaujeu, Saint-Etienne-des-Oullières, Saint- Etienne-la-Varenne, Saint-Georges-de-Reneins, Saint-Germain-sur-l'Arbresle, Saint-Jean-d'Ardières, Saint-Jean-des-Vignes, Saint-Julien, Saint-Just-d'Avray, Saint-Lager, Saint-Laurent-d'Oingt, Saint- Loup, Sainte-Paule, Saint-Romain-de-Popey, Saint-Vérand, Salles-Arbuissonnas-en-Beaujolais, Sarcey, Taponas, Ternand, Theizé, Vaux-en-Beaujolais, Vauxrenard, Vernay, Villefranche-sur-Saône, Ville-sur-Jarnioux et Villié-Morgon ;

Saône-et-Loire department: Aluze, Ameugny, Azé, Barizey, Beaumont-sur-Grosne, Berzé-la- Ville, Berzé-le-Châtel, Bissey-sous-Cruchaud, Bissy-la-Mâconnaise, Bissy-sous-Uxelles, Bissy-sur- Fley, Blanot, Bonnay, Bouzeron, Boyer, Bray, Bresse-sur-Grosne, Burgy, Burnand, Bussières, Buxy, Cersot, Chagny, Chaintré, Chalon-sur-Saône, Chamilly, Champagny-sous-Uxelles, Champforgeuil, Chânes, Change, Chapaize, La Chapelle-de-Bragny, La Chapelle-de-Guinchay, La Chapelle-sous- Brancion, Charbonnières, Chardonnay, La Charmée, Charnay-lès-Mâcon, Charrecey, Chasselas, Chassey-le-Camp, Château, Châtenoy-le-Royal, Chaudenay, Cheilly-lès-Maranges, Chenôves, Chevagny-lès-Chevrières, Chissey-lès-

Mâcon, Clessé, Cluny, Cormatin, Cortambert, Cortevaix, Couches, Crêches-sur-Saône, Créot, Cruzille, Culles-les-Roches, Curtil-sous-Burnand, Davayé, Demigny, Dennevy, Dezize-lès-Maranges, Donzy-le-National, Donzy-le-Pertuis, Dracy-le-Fort, Dracy- lès-Couches, Epertully, Etrigny, Farges-lès-Chalon, Farges-lès-Mâcon, Flagy, Fleurville, Fley, Fontaines, Fuissé, Genouilly, Germagny, Givry, Granges, Grevilly, Hurigny, Igé, Jalogny, Jambles, Jugy, Jully-lès-Buxy, Lacrost, Laives, Laizé, Lalheue, Leynes, Lournand, La Loyère, Lugny, Mâcon, Malay, Mancey, Martailly-lès-Brancion, Massilly, Massy, Mellecey, Mercurey, Messey-sur-Grosne, Milly-Lamartine, Montagny-lès-Buxy, Montbellet, Montceaux-Ragny, Moroges, Nanton, Ozenay, Paris-l'Hôpital, Péronne, Pierreclos, Plottes, Préty, Prissé, Pruzilly, Remigny, La Roche-Vineuse, Romanèche-Thorins, Rosey, Royer, Rully, Saint-Albain, Saint-Ambreuil, Saint-Amour-Bellevue, Saint- Boil, Saint-Clément-sur-Guye, Saint-Denis-de-Vaux, Saint-Désert, Saint-Gengoux-de-Scissé, Saint- Gengoux-le-National, Saint-Germain-lès-Buxy, Saint-Gervais-sur-Couches, Saint-Gilles, Saint-Jean- de-Trézy, Saint-Jean-de-Vaux, Saint-Léger-sur-Dheune, Saint-Mard-de-Vaux, Saint-Martin-Belle- Roche, Saint-Martin-du-Tartre, Saint-Martin-sous-Montaigu, Saint-Maurice-de-Satonnay, Saint-Maurice-des-Champs, Saint-Maurice-lès-Couches, Saint-Pierre-de-Varennes, Saint-Rémy, Saint- Sernin-du-Plain, Saint-Symphorien-d'Ancelles, Saint-Vallerin, Saint-Vérand, Saint-Ythaire, Saisy, La Salle, Salornay-sur-Guye, Sampigny-lès-Maranges, Sancé, Santilly, Sassangy, Saules, Savigny-sur- Grosne, Sennecey-le-Grand, Senozan, Sercy, Serrières, Sigy-le-Châtel, Sologny, Solutré-Pouilly, Taizé, Tournus, Uchizy, Varennes-lès-Mâcon, Vaux-en-Pré, Vergisson, Vers, Verzé, Le Villars, La Vineuse, Vinzelles et Viré ;

Yonne department: Accolay, Aigremont, Annay-sur-Serin, Arcy-sur-Cure, Asquins, Augy, Auxerre, Avallon, Bazarnes, Bernouil, Bessy-sur-Cure, Bleigny-le-Carreau, Censy, Champlay, Champs-sur-Yonne, Champvallon, Chamvres, Charentenay, Châtel-Gérard, Cheney, Chevannes, Chitry, Coulangeron, Coulanges-la-Vineuse, Cravant, Cruzy-le-Châtel, Dannemoine, Dyé, Epineuil, Escamps, Escolives-Sainte-Camille, Gy-l'Evêque, Héry, Irancy, Island, Joigny, Jouancy, Junay, Jussy, Lichères-près-Aigremont, Lucy-sur-Cure, Mélisey, Merry-Sec, Migé, Molay, Molosmes, Montigny-la- Resle, Mouffy, Moulins-en-Tonnerois, Nitry, Noyers, Ouanne, Paroy-sur-Tholon, Pasilly, Pierre- Perthuis, Pontigny, Quenne, Roffey, Rouvray, Sacy, Saint-Bris-le-Vineux, Saint-Cyr-les-Colons, Sainte-Pallaye, Saint-Père, Sainte-Vertu, Sarry, Senan, Serrigny, Tharoiseau, Tissey, Tonnerre, Tronchoy, Val-de-Mercy, Vallan, Venouse, Venoy, Vermenton, Vézannes, Vézelay, Vézinnes, Villeneuve-Saint-Salves, Villiers-sur-Tholon, Vincelles, Vincelottes, Volgré et Yrouerre.

V. – Grape varieties

The wines come exclusively from the chardonnay B variety.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density

- The vines present a minimum planting density of 5,500 plants per hectare, with an average spacing between rows less than or equal to 1.20 metre, with the exception of vines planted on slopes greater than or equal to 40 % for which this spacing is less than or equal to 1.60 metre;

- Where the spacing is irregular, the spacing between rows does not exceed 2 metres;

- The vines present a spacing, between plants within the same row, greater than or equal to 0.80 metre.

b) – Pruning rules

The wines come from vines pruned according to the following provisions:

GENERAL PROVISIONS

The vines are pruned with a maximum of 14 free eyes (buds) per plant and a maximum of 10 free eyes per square metre:

- either by short pruning (vines trained in Royat cordon);

- or by long pruning (single and double Guyot pruning and Chablis pruning).

PARTICULAR PROVISION

Whatever the pruning method, the vines may be pruned with additional free eyes provided that, at the phenological stage corresponding to 11 or 12 leaves, the number of fruit-bearing shoots of the year per plant is less than or equal to the number of free eyes defined for the pruning rules.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height

- The height of the trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.6 times the average spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit;

- The vines are compulsorily trellised and the trellising is maintained.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at:

- 10,500 kilograms per hectare for wines liable to benefit from the controlled designation of origin "Chablis";

- 10,000 kilograms per hectare for wines liable to benefit from the controlled designation of origin "Chablis" supplemented by the term "premier cru".

e) – Threshold for missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, which is reflected in particular by:

- the control of a good sanitary condition, making it possible to obtain healthy foliage and healthy berries;

- the upkeep of the soil, namely the control of the grassing by a grassing height less than half the trellising height (height between the ground and the top trellising wire), and the control of erosion by an absence of apparent root.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment that constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir:

- The permanent grassing of the headlands and banks is compulsory; the destruction of the vegetal cover is tolerated occasionally during soil re-levelling works;

- Any substantial modification of the morphology, of the subsoil, of the arable layer or of the elements making it possible to guarantee the integrity and the durability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin is prohibited, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works.

b) – Vine plantings and replacements are carried out with healthy plant material that has been the subject of a hot-water treatment or any other method making it possible to combat flavescence dorée.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

b) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest. The harvest is protected from the rain during its transport and at its reception.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

The sugar content of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume of the wines meet the following characteristics:

	MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)	**MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
AOC "Chablis"	161	10 %
Wines liable to benefit from the term "premier cru"	170	10.5 %

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield and limit yield

The yield and the limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code are fixed at:

	YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)	**LIMIT YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)**
AOC "Chablis"	60	75
Wines liable to benefit from the term "premier cru"	58	73

2° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any variety other than that permitted for the appellation.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Analytical standards. The finished wines, ready to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, present a maximum content of fermentable sugars (glucose + fructose) of:

- 3 grams per litre;

- or 4 grams per litre, if the total acidity is greater than or equal to 55.10 milliequivalents per litre, i.e. 4.13 grams per litre, expressed as tartaric acid (or 2.7 grams per litre, expressed as H2SO4).

b) – Oenological practices and physical treatments.

- The use of pieces of wood is prohibited;

- After enrichment, the wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13 %;

- After enrichment, the wines liable to benefit from the term "premier cru" do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13.5 %.

c) – Prohibited equipment. Continuous presses are prohibited.

d) – Vat capacity. Every operator has an overall vat capacity (vinification and storage) at least equal to the volume of wine vinified for the harvest of the previous year, entered either on the harvest declaration in proportion to the evolution of the area in production of the holding, or on the production declaration.

e) – Upkeep of the cellar and equipment. The cellar and the equipment are well maintained; this is reflected in particular by:

- a general hygiene of the elaboration premises with a state of general cleanliness, maintained floors, an adequate drainage and a covering avoiding stagnation;

- a separation and a specificity of the premises: the premises not having the same functions must be separated, such as the storage zones for plant-protection products, cleaning products or hydrocarbons from the vinification, ageing and dry-materials storage premises (corks, cartons);

- an absence of risk or odorous substances in the vinification, ageing and storage premises (odour).

f) – Other provisions. The temperature of the containers, during the ageing phase, is controlled and less than or equal to 25 °C.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- the analysis reports carried out before or after packaging.

These reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates a protected storage place for the wines packaged in bottles.

4° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer

The wines are placed on the market for the consumer in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area extends over a set of hillsides nestled at the heart of the plateaux of the “Auxerrois”, in the Paris Basin. The “Chablisien” is a small, well-circumscribed region corresponding to the reliefs bordering the valley of the Serein, a tributary of the Yonne, in its course through the heart of the “Côte des Bars”. It thus extends over 17 communes of the Yonne department, to the east of Auxerre.

The cuesta of the “Côte des Bars”, a large geomorphological structure exposing sediments dated to the Upper Jurassic, is a relief formed of hard limestone, the “Calcaire du Barrois”, forming a corniche above a long slope with a subsoil of compact and impermeable marls (clay limestones), the “Marnes à exogyra virgula”, rich in small comma-shaped oysters that gave their name to the formation. Beneath the marls, a limestone level forms a small topographic step near the valley bottom (“Calcaire à Astartes”). The marls constituting the slope are most often masked by a mantle of scree mixing fine materials and coarser limestone elements. The drop of the côte front reaches 120 to 130 metres, the altitudes remaining moderate. The highest point of the plateau does not exceed 320 metres.

The Chablis landscape is very original. Large, slightly concave slopes, occupied by the vine, are dominated by a wooded limestone corniche, closing the perspectives, open only along the axis of the Serein valley. A multitude of small valleys, often dry, cut out hillsides of varied orientations. These valleys are, in general, deep and wooded on their steepest faces, leaving room for the vine only on the best-exposed slopes.

The parcels delimited for the harvesting of the grapes occupy the flanks of the Serein valley and of its lateral valleys, encompassing the marly banks, with well-drained soils, of the outcrop zone of the "Marnes à exogyra virgula". Locally, the vineyard reaches the "Calcaire du Barrois" or the "Calcaire à Astartes", if the slopes are sufficient. The soils are always calcareous. Thin and very stony, well drained on the limestones, they are richer in clays on the marly bank. The mantle of scree covering the impermeable marl, by its variable thickness, brings nuances and constitutes a draining and well-warming layer.

The "Chablisien" bathes in an oceanic climate slightly modified by continental influences. This climate is characterised by a moderate and regular rainfall regime (only 650 millimetres annually at Auxerre), without a marked summer drought, and rather cool temperatures with an annual average of 10.8 °C. The climate is characterised by a fairly high risk of winter and spring frosts that can be catastrophic for the vine. The relatively deep relief increases this risk.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

The cultivation of the vine is attested in the "Chablisien" from the early Middle Ages. A monastery is created at Chablis in 510, then ceded, in 867, to the monks of Saint-Martin of Tours fleeing the Viking invasion in the Loire country. It seems that they developed a vineyard near the village.

In 1114, the Cistercians found, near Chablis, the Abbey of Pontigny and would gradually develop a vineyard, then install, in the town of Chablis, a cellar, the "Petit Pontigny", whose buildings still exist. Alongside the ecclesiastical estates that would endure until the French Revolution, a lay viticulture would prosper, turned towards foreign trade. Paris and the North of Europe are regular outlets.

Over the course of its history, the wine of "Chablis" remains remarkably stable in its type of dry white wine. In 1186, a donation to the abbey of Pontigny concerns a vine, giving a wine "white, and of long keeping". The authors of the 19th century also note this particularity that makes "Chablis" an exception in a wine-growing world dominated by red wines and "clairets".

Phylloxera, downy mildew and powdery mildew seriously affected the "Chablisien", which would take several decades to recover. Only during the second half of the 20th century, supported by the progress of viticulture, mechanisation and protection against frost, was the reconstitution of the vineyard really relaunched. This reconstruction is carried out in compliance with the usages, with a vineyard intended for the sole production of dry white wines.

The designation of origin "Chablis" is progressively framed by a series of judgments between 1920 and 1932. While the heart of the geographical area and the character of the wines are the subject of consensus, the debates bear on the limits of the territory as well as on the qualities of wine able to benefit from the name of "Chablis". Progressively, the geographical area takes shape, relying even on a geological expertise associating the territory of the designation of origin with the "Kimmeridgian marls". In 1929, a judgment of the Auxerre court finally lays the foundations of the designation of origin, without the geological reference. The wines of "Chablis" are recognised as a controlled designation of origin in 1938, on the basis of the conditions fixed by the 1929 judgment.

The wines of "Chablis" come from the chardonnay B variety alone, reputed to give the great white wines of Burgundy. At Chablis, it reigns supreme and gives birth to a whole hierarchy of "crus", reflections of the very varied climatic and topographic conditions. The wines from the best situations have acquired a renown that has distinguished them under the term "premier cru". The "climats" (usage name, most often a lieudit name) classified as "premier cru" occupy the best-exposed hillsides and are precisely delimited. On the right bank of the Serein, the historic "climats" are classified, attested from the Middle Ages. On the left bank, more recently revealed "climats" are classified. These "climats" number 40, which can be grouped under 17 names. These "climats" are situated on the great "côtes" individualised by the complex relief.

The vineyard of "Chablis" is traditionally managed by long pruning. The traditional pruning known as "Chablis pruning" is well suited to the difficult climatic conditions, while ensuring a regular and moderate production. Guyot pruning, single or double, generalised to the whole of the Burgundy vineyards in the 19th century, is also practised. The development of a high-performing plant material by clonal selection favours the development of a short pruning allowing a good regulation of the vegetation. The vines are trellised, generally planted in the direction of the slope. If this arrangement facilitates the drying of the clay soils, it also poses problems of erosion, compensated by a return to soil working and to grassing.

Faced with the risk of frost, greater here than in most vineyards, the wine-growers invent methods of combat such as sprinkling and the heating of the parcels, which require a collective organisation and an alert system when the temperature falls dangerously.

The producers created their first union, in 1908, in order to combat effectively the usurpations of the name. In 1923, a cooperative cellar is created at Chablis, "la Chablisienne", which still brings together 25 % of the producers. The vineyard covers, in 2008, an area of about 4,000 hectares, for an average annual production of 233,000 hectolitres.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

"Chablis" is a dry white wine, lively and fruity, characterised by its minerality. It gains in aromatic complexity and in finesse, with age, acidity and minerality ensuring it a character of freshness. The wines benefiting from the term "premier cru" may be more fruity or, on the contrary, more mineral according to the provenance of the grapes, then declining the various pedological and mesoclimatic situations of the territory. These wines are cellaring wines, reaching their fullness when they are kept for 8 to 10 years.

3° – Causal interactions

The wines, exclusively white, benefiting from the controlled designation of origin "Chablis" owe their lively and mineral character to the cool oceanic climate of the geographical area. The mesoclimatic conditions mark the viticultural potential, and the expression of the wines is particularly sensitive to the conditions of the vintage. The delimited parcel area for the harvesting of the grapes thus favours the parcels situated on the hillsides, in order to ensure a good drainage and an early warming of the soil.

"Chablis" occupies a particular place within the Burgundy whole, by the apparent simplicity of its "territory" with a simple geological context, a single variety, a single type of wine. Yet, the combination of a complex topography and a difficult climate, generating mesoclimatic and pedological nuances, generates a great diversity of environmental conditions. The producers have developed, over the generations, specific know-how allowing them to draw the best from the chardonnay B variety, in this particular environment. They have, for example, favoured pruning techniques regulating the yield as well as possible and thus ensuring an optimal ripeness, and developed means of combating frosts.

This great variety of conditions manifests itself in the nuances it brings to the wines. The original character of the wines of "Chablis" then declines, ranging from the fruity to the mineral. The richness of this palette, supported by a long and prestigious history, has been valorised by the recognition of numerous "climats" distinguished under the term "premier cru".

The strong personality of the wines, recognised over time, has made it the archetype of the great dry white wines. The "Chablis type" is known throughout the world and has moreover often given rise to usurpations, the name being even sometimes abusively considered as a generic term. The wines of "Chablis" are appreciated throughout the world. Export represents 60 % of sales.

XI. – Transitional measures

Training methods

Parcels of vines in place before 28 March 2003, not complying with the provisions relating to the planting density and to the spacing between rows laid down in the present specification, continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until their complete grubbing-up.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Chablis" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The name of a climat that may be associated with the term “premier cru” is placed immediately after the name of the controlled designation of origin and printed in characters whose dimensions are not greater, both in height and in width, than those of the characters composing the name of the controlled designation of origin.

b) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, provided that:

- it is the name of a registered lieu-dit;

- it appears on the harvest declaration;

- it does not appear in the same visual field as the compulsory indications.

The name of the registered lieu-dit is printed in characters whose dimensions do not exceed 2 millimetres.

c) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the term “premier cru” may specify the larger geographical unit “Vin de Bourgogne” or “Grand Vin de Bourgogne”.

d) – When the indication of the variety is specified on the labelling, this indication does not appear in the same visual field as the compulsory indications, and is printed in characters whose dimensions do not exceed 2 millimetres.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before movement between approved warehouse keepers and at the latest on 10 December of the year of harvest. It indicates in particular:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied in particular by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

2. Prior declaration of transaction and removals

Every operator wishing to market in bulk a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes, to the approved control body, a transaction declaration for the lot concerned within time limits set in the control plan, between six and fifteen working days before any removal. This declaration, accompanied where applicable by a copy of the purchase contract, specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the identification of the containers;

- the identity of the buyer.

In the event of removals carried out for volumes lower than those determined in the transaction declaration, the operator informs the approved control body in writing.

3. Declaration of release for consumption

Every operator declares each lot of wine, intended to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, to the approved control body. This declaration may also be established for already-packaged lots. It is made within time limits set in the control plan, between six and fifteen working days before the release for consumption or before the dispatch of the lots concerned from the operator's cellars. It specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the lot number for already-packaged wines;

- the identification of the containers for non-packaged wines.

However, the making available, by the operator, of the register referred to in Article D. 645-18 II of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, to the approved control body, constitutes a declaration of release for consumption in accordance with the arrangements set in the control plan.

4. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to carry out a dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan, between six and fifteen working days before any dispatch.

5. Fallback (repli) declaration

Every operator carrying out a fallback of a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin into a more general controlled designation of origin sends, to the defence and management body and to the approved control body, a monthly declaration at the latest on the 1st working day following the tenth day of each month. This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the more general controlled designation of origin of fallback;

- the volume that was the subject of the fallback;

- the vintage;

- the state of the fallback lot (bulk, bottle, hermetic vacuum-sealed containers, etc.);

- the date of the fallback.

The approved control body transmits without delay a copy of the monthly declaration to the approved control body for the more general controlled designation of origin concerned. The defence and management body transmits without delay, to the defence and management body of the more general controlled designation of origin concerned, the list of operators having made a monthly fallback declaration as well as a summary statement indicating: the more general controlled designation of origin of fallback; the volume that was the subject of the fallback; the vintage(s); the state of the fallback lot(s) (bulk, bottle, hermetic vacuum-sealed containers, etc.).

6. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends to the defence and management body and to the approved control body a monthly declaration within

time limits set in the control plan. This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the volume that was the subject of the downgrading;

- the vintage;

- the date of the downgrading.

7. Reworking of parcels

Before any development or any works liable to modify the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer (including any addition of exogenous soil) or the elements making it possible to guarantee the integrity and the durability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works, the operator sends a declaration to the defence and management body at least four weeks before the date scheduled for the start of the envisaged works. The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

II. – Keeping of registers

General plan of the storage and vinification premises

Every vinifying operator keeps up to date and available for the approved control body a general plan of the storage and vinification premises, allowing in particular the number, designation and capacity of the containers to be identified.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Location of the operators in the immediate proximity area	Documentary check
A2 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	- Documentary check: up-to-date CVI parcel record; - Check in the field.
A3 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties, monitoring of transitional measures, planting density, plant material)	- Documentary check; - Check in the field.
A4 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities	
Vat capacity	- Documentary check: general plan of the storage premises; - On-site check.
Ageing (temperature control and ageing duration)	- Documentary check: declaration of release for consumption or bottling register; - On-site check.
Condition of upkeep of the cellar and equipment (hygiene)	On-site check
Protected storage place	On-site check
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Pruning	Check in the field
Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
Cultivation and sanitary condition of the vine (sanitary condition of the foliage and berries,	Check in the field

soil upkeep, trellising upkeep)	
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Ripeness of the grapes	- Documentary check: recording of maturity monitoring; - Check in the field.
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices…)	- Documentary check: enrichment, acidification, deacidification register; - On-site check.
Stock accounts, analytical traceability	Documentary check: register keeping, analysis reports
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration. — Missing vines	- Documentary check (up-to-date list); - Check in the field.
Authorised yield	Documentary check: check of declarations, monitoring of the authorisations granted by the INAO services, after enquiry by the said services upon individual request of the operator
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield	Documentary check: monitoring of destruction certificates
Individual Complementary Volume (VCI)	Documentary check: harvest declaration, VCI register
Claim declaration	- Documentary check and on-site check: compliance with the arrangements and deadlines, consistency with the harvest declaration, production declaration; - Control of the placing into circulation of the products.
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines (at transaction or at removal)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Packaged wines (before or after preparation for release for consumption)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots
D – PRESENTATION OF THE PRODUCTS	
Labelling	On-site check

II. – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
TSA 30003
93555 – MONTREUIL Cedex
Tel: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00
Fax: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.04
Email: contact@inao.gouv.fr

The control of compliance with the present specification is carried out on the basis of an approved control plan and by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence and having received delegation from the INAO.